

Course Syllabus



OPMGT 540 A

Sustainable Design of Global Supply Chains

Immersion (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/immersion-2>)

Module 1 (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/module-1-introduction-to-supply-chain-management-slash-supply-chain-management-strategies-2>)

2 (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/module-2-flexibility-in-global-supply-chain-management-2>)

3 (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/module-3-risk-management-in-global-supply-chain-management-2>)

4 (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/module-4-global-network-optimization-and-tax-efficient-supply-chain-management-2>)

5 (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/module-5-applying-supply-chain-techniques-in-a-complex-global-setting-2>)

Solutions (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/solutions>)

Reviews (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/review-sessions-schedule-and-materials>)



Course Syllabus



Download the Syllabus

To download the most up to date version of this Syllabus, you can print this page from a web browser (for the best experience, we recommend printing from Firefox or Chrome).

- Click the + ("Expand All Panels") icon to expand heading sections (below "Syllabus Content" and above "Download the Syllabus")
- Print page
 - Ctrl / Command + P



- [How to print web pages in Firefox](https://support.mozilla.org/en-US/kb/how-print-web-pages-firefox)  [_\(https://support.mozilla.org/en-US/kb/how-print-web-pages-firefox\)](https://support.mozilla.org/en-US/kb/how-print-web-pages-firefox)
- [Print from Chrome](https://support.google.com/chrome/answer/1069693?hl=en&co=GENIE.Platform%3DDesktop)  [_\(https://support.google.com/chrome/answer/1069693?hl=en&co=GENIE.Platform%3DDesktop\)](https://support.google.com/chrome/answer/1069693?hl=en&co=GENIE.Platform%3DDesktop)
- Save to PDF

Course Overview

About this Course

Course Name & Number	OPMGT 540 A: Sustainable Design of Global Supply Chains
Quarter	Winter 2026
Start & End Dates	01/04/2026 - 03/15/2026
Prerequisites	None
Credits	2 credits
Delivery Format	Blended

Course Overview

As firms seek to improve their global competitive positioning, they must consider a variety of factors in determining their supply chain strategies. These factors include proximity to relatively cheap inputs, benefit of locating near major markets, building of strategic alliances to acquire technological and competitive knowledge, sustainability considerations, etc. We will learn to make strategic

and operational decisions to sustainably design and manage a global supply chain: where to locate facilities, where to source from, how to coordinate worldwide operations to enhance performance, how to manage risk, how to account for relevant legal and tax issues, while being considerate to the 3Ps of sustainability: planet, people, and profit.

Course Learning Objectives

The course will help students to

- Be able to identify major decisions involved in SCM, explain how they come together, and find examples of these decisions in practical applications.
- Distinguish between different supply chain strategies: responsive and efficient, match the strategies with the product type.
- Design effective flexibility strategies (flexible sourcing, flexible production, flexible capacity) for global supply chains.



- Hedge risk using a combination of operational and financial tools.
- Identify different supply chain risks and design effective prevention and response strategies.
- Effectively manage suppliers based on their risk profile.
- Optimize global supply chains using optimization and visualization tools.
- Understand the impact of international trade and taxation regulations on supply chain performance and incorporate these considerations into supply chain optimization models.

Faculty and TA Information

Professor



Masha Shunko

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(<mailto:mshunko@uw.edu>)

Ph: 206-685-8599

Office: PACCAR 420

Office Hours: By
Appointment

TA



Sanchita Das

sanchd20@uw.edu
(<mailto:sanchd20@uw.edu>)

Office Hours: Friday
4:00 PM to 5:00 PM via
Zoom

Instructor Bio

Professor Masha Shunko is an expert in supply chain management, service operations, and behavioral aspects of operational efficiency. A native of Estonia, Professor Shunko received a PhD degree in Operations Management from Carnegie Mellon University and, before joining Foster School in 2015, she taught at Purdue University. Masha earned multiple teaching awards, including the PACCAR award in 2020. She consulted Microsoft, Caterpillar, JD Power, and several medical organizations, including the Mayo Clinic. Masha is a vice president of the board of directors of the newly founded Seattle Universal Math Museum and is a board member at the Responsible Research in Business and Management organization.

Communication

All instructor correspondence will be sent to your @uw.edu email account.

UW Email and the Canvas Discussion Forums in this course are the official means of communication for this class. Students are expected to read and act upon email in a timely fashion. Students should check their email regularly along with the Announcements section of this course.

We will communicate with you using Canvas Announcements within this course. You should **ensure that your Canvas notifications are set**  (<https://community.instructure.com/en/kb/articles/662894-how-do-i-manage-my-canvas-notification-settings>) accordingly.

We **will not** regularly check the Canvas inbox -- direct email will be most effective way to contact us.

Course Structure and Format

Time Commitment

This 2 credit course requires approximately 5-6 hours of work per module. Please expect to spend more time during those modules which include larger assignments.

Delivery Method

This course uses Canvas for the facilitation of communications between faculty and students, posting course materials and activities, submission of assignments, and posting of grades.

Organization

This course is organized into modules, which correspond (approximately) to weeks in the academic quarter. For details, activities, and exact dates, please review the Modules section of our Canvas site.

Module #	Module Topic
1	Introduction To Supply Chain Management
2	Flexibility In Global Supply Chain Management
3	Risk Management In Global Supply Chain Management
4	Global Network Optimization and Tax-efficient Supply Chain Management
5	Applying Supply Chain Techniques In A Complex Global Setting

Class Sessions

Immersion

Immersion takes place face to face on the Seattle campus. This course will have one Immersion session:

- Saturday 01/10/26 from 2:00 - 3:30 PM PT - in Founders Hall 370



For additional details, review the [Immersion section of the Module 0 page](https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/immersion-2) (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/immersion-2>) within the Canvas course.

Please also review the program's attendance and participation policy below.

Foster Live

Foster Live takes place over Zoom in Module 5.

- Wednesday 03/04/2026 from 6:00 PM - 8:00 PM

For additional details, review the [Module 5 page](https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/module-5-applying-supply-chain-techniques-in-a-complex-global-setting-2) (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/module-5-applying-supply-chain-techniques-in-a-complex-global-setting-2>) within the Canvas course. Please also review the program's attendance and participation policy.

Review Sessions

This course will have optional review sessions led by our TA on Thursday evenings during Modules 1 and 4.

Please review the [Review Sessions Schedule and Materials page](https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/review-sessions-schedule-and-materials) (<https://canvas.uw.edu/courses/1870298/pages/review-sessions-schedule-and-materials>) for exact dates and details.

Course Components

Readings

There is no textbook for the course. There will be a packet compiled of several chapters and articles provided for the course.

Case Studies

For the case assignments, follow the instructions and questions posted on Canvas. Each case has several discussion questions and some quantitative analysis questions. There is no need to write an additional executive summary, conclusion etc. for your cases in this class. All case assignments are to be done in teams of 4 - 5 students. You can use internet sources and AI tools to do background research and to help you with structuring/writing your responses, however, you cannot use AI and or internet tools to generate solutions and/or answers to posed questions and problems.

Individual Assignments

There are two individual assignments (Module 2 and Module 4). Follow the directions on Canvas to complete the assignments. **Do NOT use generative AI or Internet search.**



Video

Most modules will include several short video segments that cover important topics in the Module.

Discussions

Most modules will include one or more Discussion Board topics in Canvas. Notice that most of the discussions consist of two parts: 1) answer the posted questions (this part will be graded towards the Discussion points); and 2) commenting on your peers' answers (this part will be graded towards the Class Participation points).

Instructions for completing these required assignments are included within the Module pages.

Online Quizzes

Quizzes are designed to test your understanding of the material and consist of several multiple choice, True/False, and short answer/calculation questions. Notice that you will have only one attempt to submit your answers. All quizzes are timed, you have 30 minutes since the moment you open the quiz to complete it. You will be able to see the answers on Canvas right after the deadline, I will also publish the solution key with explanations after the deadline. The quizzes are to be done individually. You can use your notes, my slides, and the textbook when solving the quizzes. **Do NOT use generative AI or Internet search.**

Supply Chain Project

In teams of 4 - 5, prepare an analysis of a supply chain of your choice (please contact me if you need help selecting a supply chain).

Your analysis should include, but is not limited to:

- Brief description of the supply chain strategy (efficient or responsive, flexibility strategy, etc), using knowledge from Modules 1 and 2;
- Identify three major sources of risk faced by the supply chain and classify the risks using the readings and frameworks from Module 3;
- Map of the supply chain (including major players and locations) and the analysis of location choices (explain the rational behind location choices) using knowledge from Module 4;
- Describe the company's current sustainability state and initiatives, discuss the implications throughout the supply chain (remember to focus on the triple bottom line), and propose ways for improvement – we will discuss sustainability implications starting from the Immersion session and throughout Modules 1 – 4.

Each team needs to prepare a deck of presentation slides and record a ~10 minute presentation video. Please record a video, upload it to Canvas, and post a link to the corresponding Discussion 5 by the due date in Canvas.



Each team will have to watch all videos posted by other teams and post comments/questions on the discussion board during the following week. Each team will then have to vote on the Presentation Survey form regarding which video they found to be the most informative.

Attendance, Participation, and Grading

Assessments and Activity Overview

Activity Type	#	% Value
Assignments (Team)	3	15%
Assignments (Individual)	2	20%
Discussions	4	15%
Quizzes	5	15%
Global Supply Chain Game	1	10%
Supply Chain Project	1	20%
Class Participation	1	5%

Attendance and Participation

The knowledge and skills that you will gain in this course will highly depend upon your full engagement. This engagement includes your attendance and active participation, and it is crucial to both your and your classmates' learning experiences.

The following information is taken from the HMBA Program Policies, as published in the HMBA Program Information Course:

Students are expected and required to attend all Program Immersion class sessions and required events, and all Foster Live class sessions.

Excused absences or virtual attendance **must** be approved by the program director, and are limited to the following situations only

- Military service
- Major personal illness
- Immediate family illness or death
- Birth or adoption of a child
- Jury duty
- Documented work emergency

Unexcused absences (including unexcused virtual attendance), resulting in missing 1 or more class sessions during Immersion will result in failing and repeating the missed course(s). Missing 1 or

more Foster Live sessions during a course will result in a grade deduction.

Class Participation

We will have multiple opportunities for you to participate in discussions throughout the course, during Immersion, Foster Live, and online via Canvas. Class participation (synchronous or asynchronous) is extremely important. The class should be a common learning experience. Thus, we want you to take ownership and initiative for the success of the class.

It is critical that you be fully prepared to lead the discussion if called upon. You should be able to demonstrate your understanding of the relevant issues and problems in the assigned readings and cases. Share your knowledge and help others understand your point of view.

Some of the criteria we will use to judge the effectiveness of your participation during these discussions include:

- Are you willing to participate?
- Do your comments show evidence of appropriate, insightful analysis of the case?
- Are your comments relevant to the discussion?
- Are you a good listener as well as speaker? Can you play off of the comments of others?
- Are you willing to test new ideas? Or are all of your comments “safe”?
- Do you work well with others during group projects

Group Work

Many assignments are performed in teams of up to 4 students in this class (case write-ups, game, and course project); I expect every team member to contribute to the final product in a fair way (this applies to case assignments and course project).

At the end of the course, I will ask every student to confidentially evaluate other team members' contribution to the team projects. These evaluations will be considered in grading of all team-based work. You can form teams in Canvas prior to Immersion, and we will finalize the teams during the Immersion.

Working on Assignments

- For quizzes: You can openly use all class materials (notes, readings, cases, videos) while working on the However, you should not use internet sources and/or generative AI tools to work on the quizzes.
- For case assignments you can use internet sources and AI tools to do background research and to help you with structuring/writing your responses, however, you cannot use AI and or internet tools to generate solutions and/or answers to posed questions and problems.



Submitting Assignments

Instructions for submitting assignments are included with the assignment descriptions within the Canvas course site. Due dates for all graded work are included in the Canvas Calendar, and in each Module page in the Canvas course.

Late or Missed Assignments

To qualify for full credit for the assignments, you must submit your work BEFORE the published assignment due dates (Pacific Time -- PT). I will post the solutions 24 hours after the assignments are due. If you submit your work after the deadline, but before the solution has been posted, you will receive a 25% penalty on your grade. No assignment will be accepted for credit after the solution has been posted.

Grading Procedure

Grades reflect your performance on assignments and adherence to deadlines. The grading turnaround time will be approximately one week. Grades will be posted in the gradebook section on the Canvas course site.

Incompletes

An Incomplete may be given only when the student has been in attendance and has done satisfactory work to within two weeks of the end of the quarter and has furnished proof satisfactory to the instructor that the work cannot be completed because of illness or other circumstances beyond the student's control.

For more information about the Incomplete Policy, please visit the Hybrid MBA Program Information Course.

Grade Appeals

For more information about the Grade Appeals Policy, please visit the Hybrid MBA Program Information Course.

Course and Program Policies

Academic Integrity

Foster Integrity Principles



I will uphold the fundamental standards of honesty, respect, and integrity and I accept the responsibility to encourage others to adhere to these standards.

HONESTY: I will be truthful with myself and others.

RESPECT: I will show consideration for others and their ideas and work.

INTEGRITY: I will be a leader of character. I will be fair in all relations with others.

Use of Generative AI

Course AI Use Policy

Warning

This course **explicitly prohibits the use of generative AI in any submitted activities.**

All work submitted for this course must be your own. Any use of generative AI tools (such as ChatGPT, CoPilot, Google Gemini, etc) when working on assignments, quizzes, or other graded activities is forbidden. Use of generative AI will be considered academic misconduct and subject to investigation.

The assignments in this class have been designed to challenge you to develop creativity, critical-thinking, and problem-solving skills. Using AI technology will limit your capacity to develop these skills and to meet the learning goals of this course.

I draw your attention to the fact that different classes at Foster could implement different AI policies, and it is the student's responsibility to conform to expectations for each course.

If you have any questions about what constitutes academic integrity in this course, please feel free to contact me to discuss your concerns.

Copyright

The course content is for class purposes only and are to be used only by the student enrolled in the course. All rights reserved. No part of this course may be reproduced, distributed, or transmitted in any form or by any means, including photography, video recordings, screen shots, or other electronic or digital methods, without the prior written permission of the instructor.

COVID-19 and Other Illness

Attendance



According to the HMBA program attendance policy: Students are expected to attend class and to participate in all graded activities. However, if you suspect that you are ill, or that you may have been exposed to COVID-19 or other serious illness, you are encouraged to remain home. Please reach out to your program director and faculty member, as soon as possible, if you expect to be absent.

To protect student privacy and the integrity of the academic experience, students will not be required to provide a medical excuse "doctor's" note to justify an absence from class due to illness. A student absent from any graded class activity or examination due to illness must request, in writing, to take a rescheduled examination or perform work judged by the instructor to be the equivalent. For some activities, you may be able to participate remotely, or watch a recording later. However, not all class sessions may be available for remote participation.

Face Coverings

The health and safety of the University of Washington community are the institution's priorities. Please review and adhere to the [UW COVID Face Covering Policy \[pdf\]](https://www.ehs.washington.edu/system/files/resources/COVID-19-face-cover-policy.pdf)  (<https://www.ehs.washington.edu/system/files/resources/COVID-19-face-cover-policy.pdf>).

Access and Accommodations

Your experience in this class is important. If you have already established accommodations with Disability Resources for Students (DRS), please communicate your approved accommodations to me at your earliest convenience so we can discuss your needs in this course.

DRS offers resources and coordinates reasonable accommodations for students with disabilities and/or temporary health conditions. Reasonable accommodations are established through an interactive process between you, your instructor(s), and DRS. It is the policy and practice of the University of Washington to create inclusive and accessible learning environments consistent with federal and state law.

If you have not yet established services through DRS, but have a temporary health condition or permanent disability that requires accommodations (conditions include but not limited to; mental health, attention-related, learning, vision, hearing, physical or health impacts), you are welcome to contact DRS at:

- Website: disability.uw.edu  (<https://depts.washington.edu/uwdrs>)
- Guide: [Getting Started / Accessing Resources](http://depts.washington.edu/uwdrs/prospective-students/getting-started)  (<http://depts.washington.edu/uwdrs/prospective-students/getting-started>)
- Email: uwdrs@uw.edu (<mailto:uwdrs@uw.edu>)
- Phone: 206-543-8924
- Fax: 206-616-8379



Course Evaluations

Course evaluations are done toward the end of the quarter during a predetermined time period. Students will have 24-48 hours to complete their course evaluation, which is delivered digitally from the UW Office of Educational Assessment.

All evaluations are anonymous and are used to make improvements to the course and are included in a faculty member's annual review. It is important to complete the evaluations and provide your honest assessment both in the quantitative and qualitative measures.

Student Grievance Procedure

For more information about the Student Grievance Policy, please visit the Hybrid MBA Program Information Course.

Non-Discrimination Policy

For more information about the Non-Discrimination Policy, please visit the Hybrid MBA Program Information Course.

Religious Accommodation Policy

Washington state law requires that UW develop a policy for accommodation of student absences or significant hardship due to reasons of faith or conscience, or for organized religious activities. The UW's policy, including more information about how to request an accommodation, is available at [Religious Accommodations Policy](https://registrar.washington.edu/staffandfaculty/religious-accommodations-policy)  (<https://registrar.washington.edu/staffandfaculty/religious-accommodations-policy>).

Accommodations must be requested within the first two weeks of this course using the [Religious Accommodations Request form](https://registrar.washington.edu/students/religious-accommodations-request)  (<https://registrar.washington.edu/students/religious-accommodations-request>).

Title IX

The University of Washington prohibits sex discrimination and sex-based harassment and expects all UW community members to respect one another in our shared academic and work environments. Sex discrimination and sex-based harassment can include sexual assault, relationship violence, stalking, unwanted sexual contact, sexual exploitation, sexual harassment, and discrimination based on sex.

Students who believe they have experienced sex discrimination or sex-based harassment are encouraged to contact a Title IX case manager by [making a Title IX report](#) .



(<https://www.washington.edu/titleix/report>). The case manager can provide guidance on available **support resources** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/titleix/supportive-measures) (<https://www.washington.edu/titleix/supportive-measures>) and **resolution options** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/titleix/resolution-options) (<https://www.washington.edu/titleix/resolution-options>).

You can also access these additional resources directly:

- The **Know Your Rights & Resources guide** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/titleix/survivor-resources) (<https://www.washington.edu/titleix/survivor-resources>) provides information for any member of the UW community who has experienced sex discrimination, sex-based harassment, or retaliation for addressing these behaviors.
- The **Pregnancy & Related Conditions web page** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/titleix/pregnant-parenting) (<https://www.washington.edu/titleix/pregnant-parenting>) provides information on support and reasonable modifications related to attending class or participating in educational activities if you are pregnant, have experienced a miscarriage or an abortion, are recovering from giving birth, are lactating, or have a related medical condition.
- **Confidential Advocates** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/sexualassault/support/advocacy) (<https://www.washington.edu/sexualassault/support/advocacy>) offer confidential support and advocacy for UW students and employees impacted by sexual assault, dating violence, domestic violence, or stalking.
- **Respondent Resources** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/cssc/respondent-resources) (<https://www.washington.edu/cssc/respondent-resources>) offer support for UW student respondents in a University resolution process.
- **SafeCampus** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/safecampus) (<https://www.washington.edu/safecampus>) offers anonymous support for anyone with safety or well-being concerns.

Please note that **certain employees** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/titleix/employee-reporting-expectations) (<https://www.washington.edu/titleix/employee-reporting-expectations>) are required to make a Title IX report if they learn about conduct that may be considered sex discrimination or sex-based harassment.

FERPA

For more information about the University's FERPA policy, please visit the Hybrid MBA Program Information Course or the University of Washington Registrar's page on **FERPA for Students** [↗](https://registrar.washington.edu/students/ferpa) (<https://registrar.washington.edu/students/ferpa>).

Safety

Call **SafeCampus** [↗](https://www.washington.edu/safecampus) (<https://www.washington.edu/safecampus>) at 206-685-7233 anytime – no matter where you work or study – to anonymously discuss safety and well-being concerns for yourself or others. SafeCampus's team of caring professionals will provide individualized support, while discussing short- and long-term solutions and connecting you with additional resources when requested.

Program Withdrawal



Students cannot withdraw from this class without withdrawing or going-on-leave from the Hybrid MBA Program. The Hybrid MBA Program is a lockstep, cohort-based model and all courses must be completed in the order in which they are offered.

For more information about Program Withdrawal, please visit the relevant section of the Hybrid MBA Program Information Course.

Technical Support

Technology Requirements

This course requires Internet access and the following:

- A web browser (for the best experience, use [Google Chrome](https://www.google.com/chrome)  (<https://www.google.com/chrome>) or [Mozilla Firefox](https://www.mozilla.org/en-US/firefox/new)  (<https://www.mozilla.org/en-US/firefox/new>)
- [Adobe Acrobat Reader](https://get.adobe.com/reader)  (<https://get.adobe.com/reader>) (free)
- Webcam, microphone, and speaker
- [Zoom software](https://zoom.us/download)  (<https://zoom.us/download>) (for video conference)
- [Microsoft Office 365 ProPlus](https://itconnect.uw.edu/wares/uware/microsoft/microsoft-office-365-proplus) (<https://itconnect.uw.edu/wares/uware/microsoft/microsoft-office-365-proplus>) (free for students & staff)

Network Use Policies

Please read the University of Washington's [Student Use of UW Computing Resources Policy](https://itconnect.uw.edu/work/appropriate-use/#students) (<https://itconnect.uw.edu/work/appropriate-use/#students>).

Technical Support

Please email fosteris@uw.edu (<mailto:fosteris@uw.edu>) (and CC instructor) if you have issues with playback or downloading of any media, Canvas issues, or Zoom-based questions.

Please provide us with your operating system and browser, in addition to a screenshot of any error message that might help us troubleshoot.

Network Outages

To monitor the status of campus networks and services, visit the [ItConnect eOutages page](https://eoutage.uw.edu) (<https://eoutage.uw.edu>).

Canvas Support



- IT Connect: [Canvas Help for Students \(https://itconnect.uw.edu/learn/tools/canvas/canvas-help-for-students\)](https://itconnect.uw.edu/learn/tools/canvas/canvas-help-for-students)
- Instructure: [Canvas Student Guides ↗ \(https://community.canvaslms.com/t5/Canvas-Student/ctp/canvas_student\)](https://community.canvaslms.com/t5/Canvas-Student/ctp/canvas_student)

Syllabus Purpose and Disclaimer

This syllabus serves as a guideline for what to expect in this class and an implicit agreement between the instructor and the student.

Before contacting the instructional staff, please review these documents first to see if your question is addressed.

Every effort will be made to avoid changing the course schedule, but adjustments may be necessary to accommodate errors, omissions, or unforeseen events (such as weather events).

In the event changes are made to the syllabus, students will be informed during class, on the course website, and via email. It is your responsibility to be aware of these changes, so please check your email and the course site often.